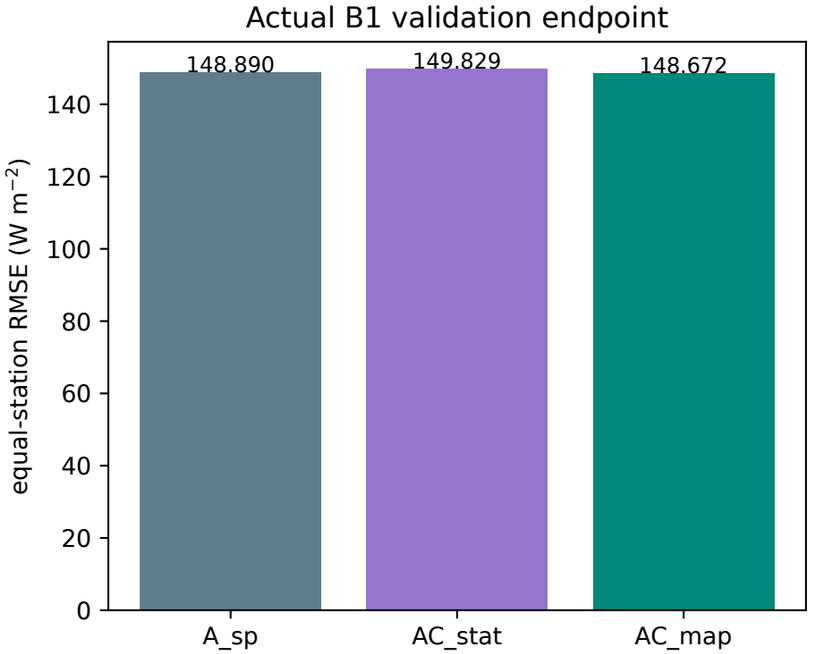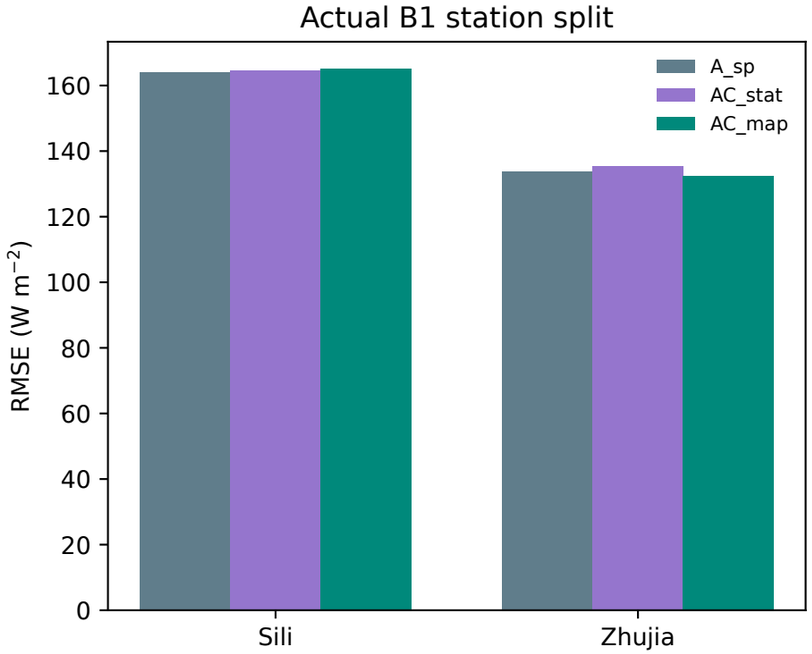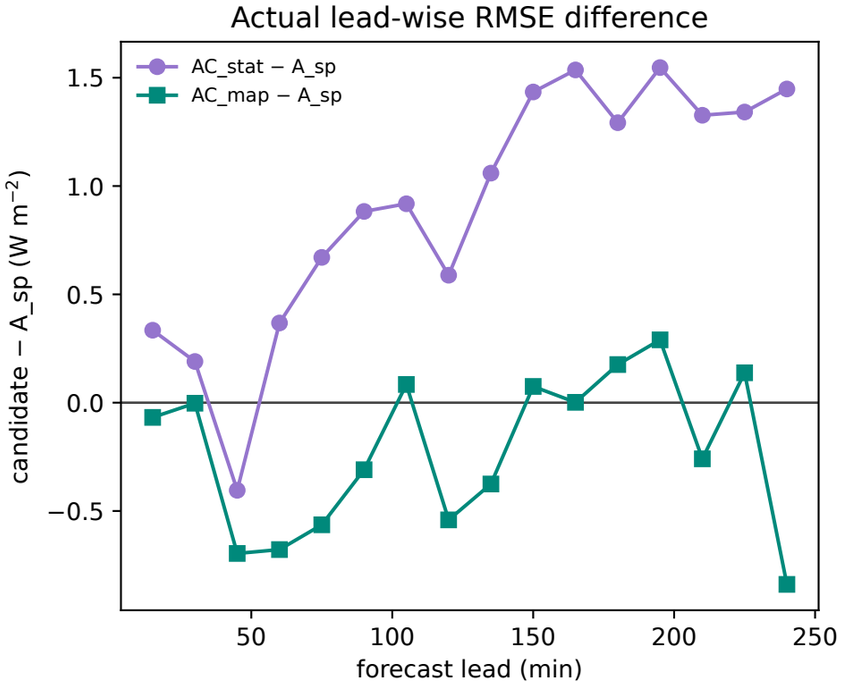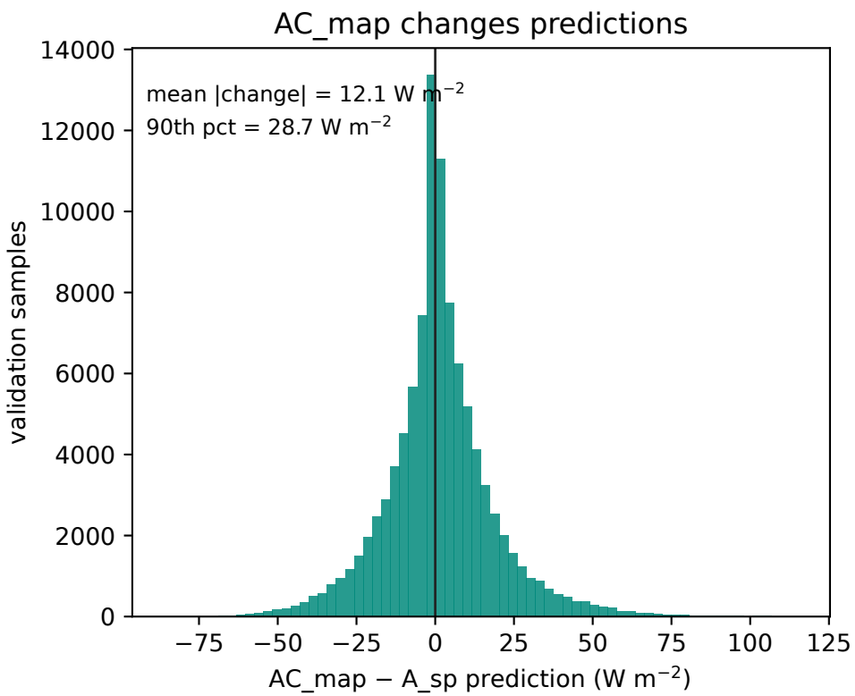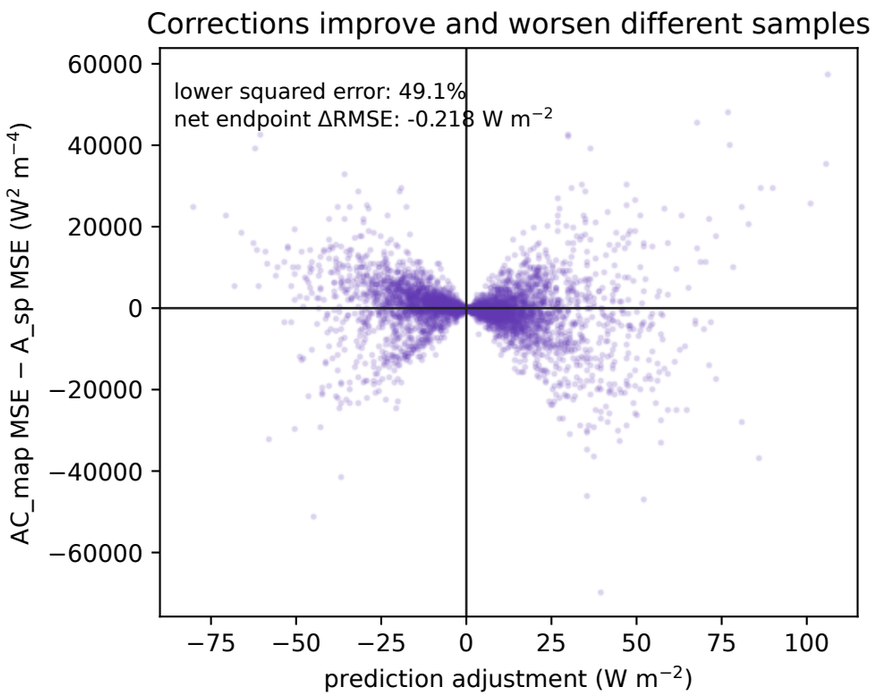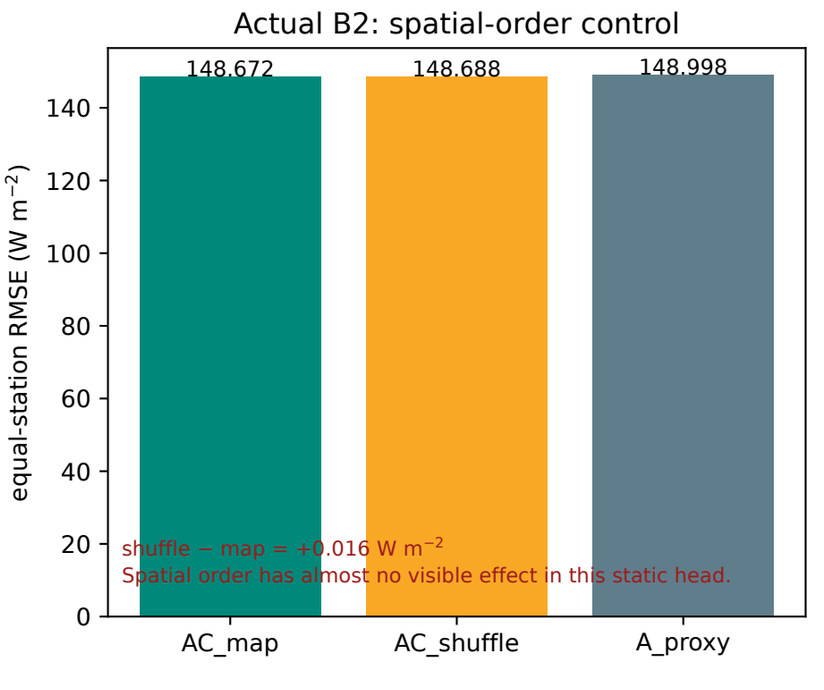Actual saved validation outputs: why the current static COT gain is small